

THE STONE AGE: PALAEOLITHIC & MESOLITHIC

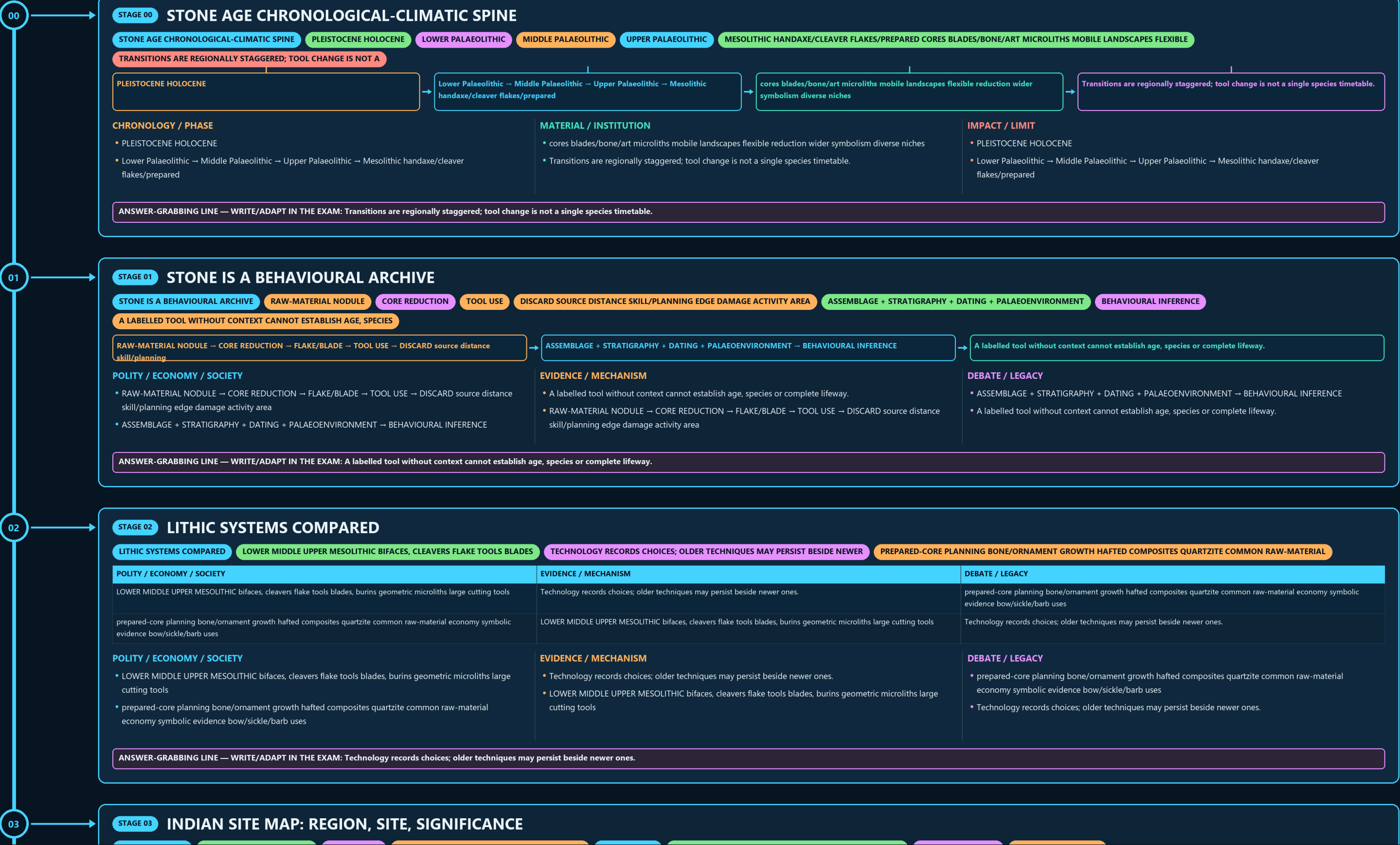
STONE AGE CHRONOLOGICAL-CLIMATIC SPINE → STONE IS A BEHAVIOURAL → LITHIC SYSTEMS COMPARED → INDIAN SITE MAP: REGION → MOBILITY-SUBSISTENCE-SOCIAL LOOP → ROCK ART AND SYMBOLIC

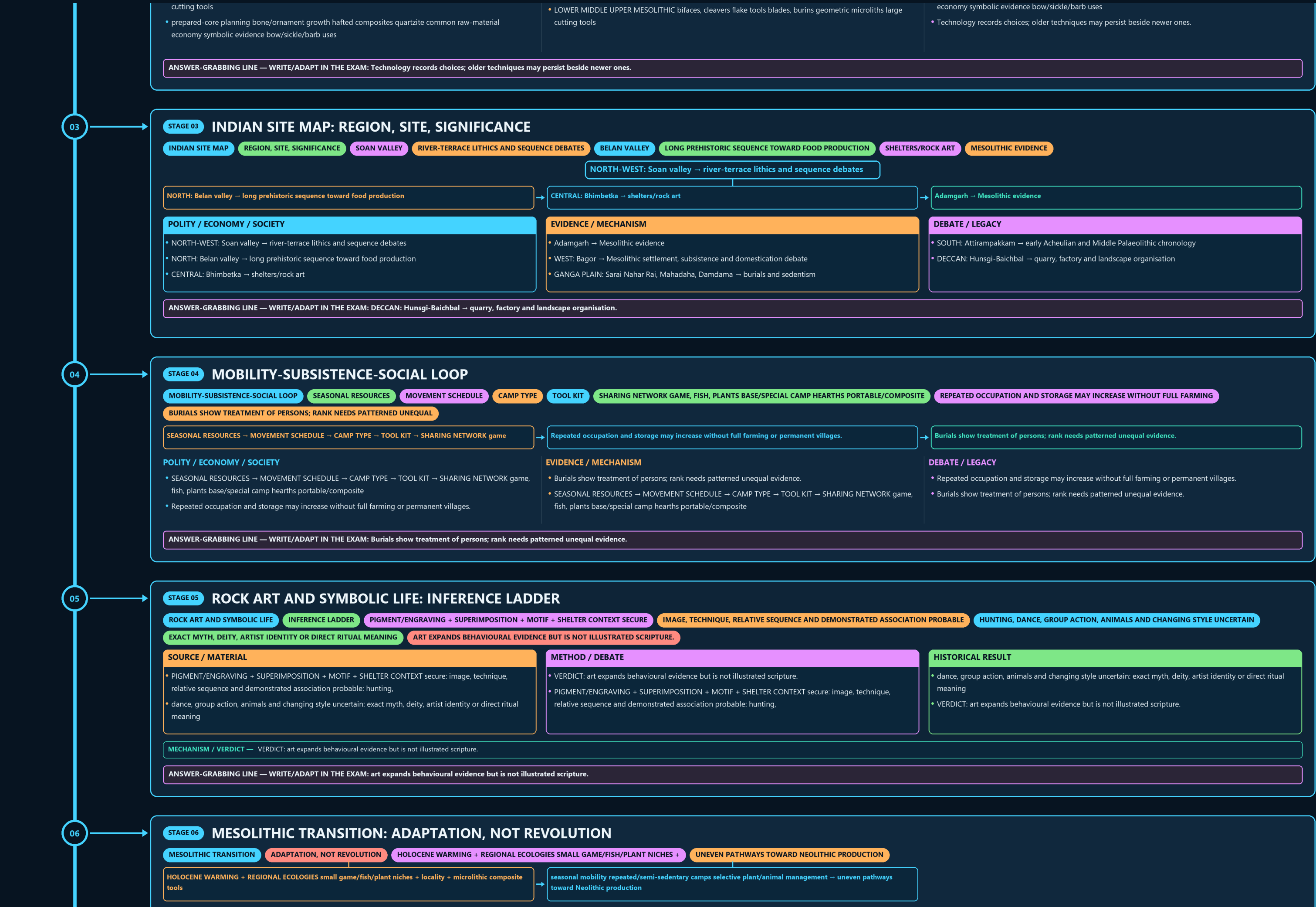
Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE Pending user review source generation g15 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA prior artefacts unchanged exact same master drives poster and tiles





ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: art expands behavioural evidence but is not illustrated scripture.

06

STAGE 06 MESOLITHIC TRANSITION: ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION

MESOLITHIC TRANSITION

ADAPTATION, NOT REVOLUTION

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES SMALL GAME/FISH/PLANT NICHES +

UNEVEN PATHWAYS TOWARD NEOLITHIC PRODUCTION

HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools

seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools
- seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools
- seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

DEBATE / LEGACY

- HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools
- seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HOLOCENE WARMING + REGIONAL ECOLOGIES small game/fish/plant niches + locality + microlithic composite tools seasonal mobility repeated/semi-sedentary camps selective plant/animal management → uneven pathways toward Neolithic production.

07

STAGE 07 LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCH

LIMITS AND CURRENT RESEARCH

SPARSE FOSSILS + DISTURBED SITES + BROAD TOOL LABELS

FALSE SHORTCUTS

ONE TOOL

ONE PEOPLE

DATE CONTEXTS, RECONSTRUCT REDUCTION SEQUENCE, COMPARE REGIONS, STATE CONFIDENCE

REFINED CHRONOMETRY AND LANDSCAPE STUDY CAN REVISE EARLY DATES.

INDIAN PREHISTORY IS A MOSAIC OF LONG CONTINUITY AND

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PROBLEM: sparse fossils + disturbed sites + broad tool labels + uncertain associations
- FALSE SHORTCUTS: one tool = one people
- innovation = migration

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- burial = hierarchy
- RESPONSE: date contexts, reconstruct reduction sequence, compare regions, state confidence
- Refined chronometry and landscape study can revise early dates.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian prehistory is a mosaic of long continuity and episodic innovation.

08

STAGE 08 STONE AGE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

STONE AGE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS

DEFINE PHASE

DIAGNOSTIC TECHNOLOGY

TWO SITES

15 MARKS

LITHIC COMPARISON

SYMBOLIC EVIDENCE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: define phase → diagnostic technology → two sites → subsistence → caution
- 15 MARKS: chronology → lithic comparison → ecology/mobility → symbolic evidence → limits

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: geological frame → methods → four-stage technology → regional site map
- economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict

DEBATE / LEGACY

- MUST DISTINGUISH: relative/absolute date; artefact/assemblage; microlith/sedentism.
- CLOSE: technology records adaptive choices, not a uniform evolutionary ladder.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: economy/social life → Mesolithic transition → historiographical verdict.

09

STAGE 09 EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. START WITH MACRO-PHASE, THEN REGIONAL SEQUENCE, DATED STRATUM

2. READ CORES, FLAKES, DEBITAGE, WEAR AND RAW MATERIAL

3. SEPARATE LITHIC TECHNOLOGY FROM HOMININ TAXONOMY, LANGUAGE AND

BROAD CHRONOLOGY GUIDES COMPARISON; SITE CONTEXT CONTROLS THE CLAIM.

SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. Read cores, flakes,debitage, wear and raw material before inferring behaviour.	VERDICT: Broad chronology guides comparison; site context controls the claim.
1. Start with macro-phase, then regional sequence, dated stratum and assemblage.	3. Separate lithic technology from hominin taxonomy, language and group identity.	EVIDENCE LADDER
SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
• EVIDENCE LADDER	• 2. Read cores, flakes,debitage, wear and raw material before inferring behaviour.	• VERDICT: Broad chronology guides comparison; site context controls the claim.
• 1. Start with macro-phase, then regional sequence, dated stratum and assemblage.	• 3. Separate lithic technology from hominin taxonomy, language and group identity.	• EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Broad chronology guides comparison; site context controls the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Broad chronology guides comparison; site context controls the claim.

1. Start with macro-phase, then regional sequence, dated stratum and assemblage.

SOURCE / MATERIAL

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Start with macro-phase, then regional sequence, dated stratum and assemblage.

2. Read cores, flakes, debitage, wear and raw material before inferring behaviour.

METHOD / DEBATE

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EVIDENCE LADDER

HISTORICAL RESULT

VERDICT: Broad chronology guides comparison; site context controls the claim.

EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Broad chronology guides comparison; site context controls the claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Broad chronology guides comparison; site context controls the claim.

10

STAGE 10

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. ACHEULIAN IS A TECHNOLOGY, LEVALLOIS A METHOD AND

2. BHIMBETKA SPANS MANY PERIODS; ROCK-ART MEANING AND DATES

3. MESOLITHIC DOMESTICATION AND SEDENTARINESS MUST BE ESTABLISHED SITE

TRANSITION MEANS CHANGING COMBINATIONS, OVERLAP AND REGIONAL COEXISTENCE.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Acheulian is a technology, Levallois a method and microlith a tool element.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

2. Bhimbetka spans many periods; rock-art meaning and dates remain indirect.

3. Mesolithic domestication and sedentariness must be established site by site.

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: Transition means changing combinations, overlap and regional coexistence.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: Transition means changing combinations, overlap and regional coexistence.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Transition means changing combinations, overlap and regional coexistence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Transition means changing combinations, overlap and regional coexistence.

11

STAGE 11

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

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ANSWER SPINE

1. USE THE 2019 DENISOVAN PYQ TO SEPARATE POPULATION

2. COMPARE PHASES THROUGH TOOLS, ECOLOGY, MOBILITY, HABITATION, ART

3. WRITE CLAIM

DATE/CONTEXT LIMIT

INDIAN PREHISTORY IS REGIONALLY VARIED HISTORY RECONSTRUCTED WITHOUT TEXTS.

ANSWER SPINE

→

1. Use the 2019 Denisovan PYQ to separate population, place and geological period.

→

2. Compare phases through tools, ecology, mobility, habitation, art and burials.

→

3. Write claim → site/assemblage → significance → date/context limit → verdict.

→

VERDICT: Indian prehistory is regionally varied history reconstructed without texts.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

ANSWER SPINE

1. Use the 2019 Denisovan PYQ to separate population, place and geological period.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

2. Compare phases through tools, ecology, mobility, habitation, art and burials.

3. Write claim → site/assemblage → significance → date/context limit → verdict.

DEBATE / LEGACY

VERDICT: Indian prehistory is regionally varied history reconstructed without texts.

ANSWER SPINE

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Indian prehistory is regionally varied history reconstructed without texts.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian prehistory is regionally varied history reconstructed without texts.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

6. CURRENT LINK

7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

Mini-timeline

1. Snapshot & core idea

2. Key classification / data

3. Study links

ADVANCED DEBATE

4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

5. UPSC Traps

6. Current link

7. Mains angles

LEGACY / NUANCE

She discusses Lower, Middle and Upper Palaeolithic sites separately, including tool types and manufacturing contexts.

Isampur is treated as a centre of stone-tool manufacture.

Middle Palaeolithic discussions include Attirampakkam and the Levallois technique.

Mesolithic levels can yield animal bones and pottery; some claims of domesticated cattle, sheep, goat, dog and pig are questioned.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

THE STONE AGE: PALAEOLITHIC & MESOLITHIC • TILE 4/4 • same master rows 8178-11412 of 11412 • end